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Dear Reader,

As usual it's a mixed bag of news in the New Year from this great land of the Indus and the Karakorum, and generally the world at large. On the global front the Russian Bear and the Kung Fu Panda have teamed up and got the American Grizzly on the back foot, somewhat, even as Pakistan gets onto the front foot with the Karachi Kings eyeball to eyeball with the Multan Sultans in a celebration of Cricket that has the entire nation riveted to its television screens.

What a waste of time and productivity, some would say. However, given the reality of the Great Resignation following the COVID ordeal which in many ways continues unabated, it's time to party! Then again, one must acknowledge the presence of cricket as a formidable tool in our PR armoury with unmatched potency when it comes to track-2 people-to-people engagement with the world.

The advent of 2022 heralds a surging tide of optimism for the future, the lame duck **GlasgowCOP26** and the ravages of global warming and climate change notwithstanding. In great measure this comes from acquiring a greater understanding of the enemy that threatens to upend our appletart.

This issue we lead with an in-depth interview of an enterprising soul whose vibrant career reflects the dynamism inherent in the Pakistani DNA. **Wasif Khan** is CEO of Dvago Pharmacy and Wellness Experts, intent upon adding quantum value to our healthcare sector.

We also feature kinetic talent digger **Kamran Ahmed Siddique** who directly addressed the issue of exponential growth in his webinar for TCS Octara titled "In 2022 Inspire Yourself to Succeed in Business and Life."

Looking over the horizon at what's coming next was the Future Summit's 5th edition co-hosted by the Martin Dow Group and Nutshell Group with Engro Corp as the Platinum Sponsors where our chairman **Mr. Khalid Awan** was a panelist on the issue of Reimagining Leadership, Productivity & the Workplace, and we carry an account of it.

There's much more that awaits your pleasure within our pages, and we thank you for your patronage even as we wish you the choicest of health, wealth and happiness in 2022. May Allah bless us all and keep us all in His protection, Ameen 🙏

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TCS Octara Programs in February 2022



February 9-10, 2022 | 10:00 am - 5:00 pm | Nine Tree Hotel - Lahore

Workshop: Bearing Damage Analysis

Facilitator: Khurram Shahzad

8 Days Left to Register!



February 15, 2022 | 11:00 am to 4:00 pm PKT at Zoom

Workshop: Strategic Thinking & Planning

Facilitator: John Bentley

14 Days Left to Register!



February 17, 2022 | 2:00 - 5:00 pm | Regent Plaza - Karachi

New Workshop: Think Again Future Proof your Brand and Marketing

Facilitator: Sarah Dawood



February 23, 2022 | 10:00 am - 5:00 pm | Regent Plaza - Karachi

Workshop: Performance Management

February 24, 2022 | 10:00 am - 5:00 pm | Regent Plaza - Karachi

Workshop: Compensation & Benefit

Facilitator: Farhan Mahmood

Octara Training Calendar 2022



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If you like to attend live webinars or want to watch the recordings, sign-up to become a member of "TCS Octara WebMail" register Click here <http://www.octara.com/webmail/>

DVAGO making positive and impactful contribution

Wasif's World of Wellness

Wasif Khan is just short of being a Millennial but exhibits all the traits of a Millennial. He is an explorer, and has ventured into challenging territories, leaving behind lucrative careers with multinationals in his quest, read thirst, to explore new horizons and grow both as a person and a professional. Then there is the cause aspect of the Millennial's motivation. Here Wasif's natural urge is to help people grow and become better versions of themselves.

Wasif's LinkedIn profile styles him as an executive driving Strategic Planning, Business Transformation, Operational Excellence and Organizational Architecture. He is NLP Certified Coach and Practitioner. He is Ex-PepsiCo/Unilever/Cadbury/Reckitt/Packages and spent one year working with a tech real estate startup. FMCG, F&B, PropTech, Pharma Retail & E-Commerce have comprised his hunting grounds.

All his experiences have added value to him and he has learnt from every interaction and exposure which have helped him in becoming not only a better professional but also these experiences acted as a catalyst for his personal and leadership development.

Startup Scale up Environment

Wasif has worked with a lot of large scale companies, however the quest to learn and explore landed him in a startup scale up environment that provides more flexibility to work with new ideas and also fulfills his vision for building new business and young talent development. **"My thought on retail pharmacy is that the retail**



environment in Pakistan is growing phenomenally and the pharmacy sector has great potential."

DVAGO Pharmacy and Wellness Experts is the full nomenclature of Wasif's new employers where he works as chief executive officer, and his passion for the job comes out quite clearly during the interview.

Wasif Khan has been with DVAGO for one year now, inspired by the vision of its board of directors where they felt it was essential to provide better health facilities to our communities, and give back to the society we live in. So the decision was taken to get into the pharmacy e-commerce and retail space.

"In March 2022 DVAGO will be 4 years old. It has experienced accelerated growth and today has 50 outlets in Karachi, Hyderabad, Bahawalpur, Multan and Lahore. We are an Omni-business and we call ourselves 'phygital' meaning that we have physical outlets and also digital. Both our business streams, retail pharmacies and online pharmacy, are growing phenomenally. We are in the process of revitalizing our online business and for that we have developed a new mobile application which will provide

"I have worked with lot of large scale companies. However, the quest to learn and explore landed me in Pakistan based startup scale up environment that provides more flexibility to work with new ideas and has enabled me to work towards my vision for building new business and young talent development"

“DVAGO is Omni-business and today has 50 outlets across multiple cities in Pakistan and we call ourselves ‘phygital’ meaning that we have physical outlets and also present on digital/ online platforms”

better user interface and experience to all our customers.”

The long term vision is to make DVAGO the country's largest Retail pharmacy and e-commerce platform. DVAGO Pharmacy & Wellness is a part of a heritage conglomerate, the G&T Group, comprising Novatex, Gatron, Bonanza Mustaqim Textiles, GAT logistics and Thal Nova power project, besides which there are other companies in the group doing substantial B to B businesses.

“In Pakistan there is a major problem of counterfeit medicines, a huge health risk for the overall population. Also, adherence to temperature control medicine is not being followed properly. The purpose of DVAGO's existence is to provide its customer with genuine medicine, stored at right temperature and ensure availability of a qualified pharmacist to provide the right quality of products, service and guidance to customers.”

People, process and technology

In formulating strategy and ensuring operational excellence I am focused on people, process and technology, says Wasif Khan. “Upon these three pillars depends business transformation. In the last one year at DVAGO we have done accelerated hiring, created new roles in demand and supply planning, business analytics, marketing, e-commerce and business automation. We are also investing in organization and people development. Developing processes is very important for a startup so when it scales up it can absorb that growth. Technology is the key going forward and I'm working with my technology transformation team to future-proofing the business. We are a professional pharmacy chain with a head office and branch operation teams. We have invested in technology and analytics software for business visibility because we feel it is extremely important to make better informed decisions both for ourselves and our business partners.”

Industry-Academia interaction

Under Wasif, DVAGO has created close partnerships with academia and signed MOUs with universities and their pharmacy departments and business schools. “We hire university students as interns and also as management

trainees. We give projects to academia that further our own business plans and support the students as well by giving them real life scenarios to work with. Industry and academia collaboration is very important to ensure a win-win partnership.”

Wasif feels it is extremely important to provide positive working environment to employees to flourish. “How can we get our people to be excited about coming to work every day? That's the question the answer to which holds the key to organizational success. People should enjoy and cherish their work environment and work with a passion for winning.”

DVAGO has invested in people and offers them career development paths. We believe in performance driven culture and provided fast track career growth to our young talent. We have a young team full of new ideas and passion in need of guidance and coaching, and that's what my leadership team and I are trying to do. We're building strategic plans that help both the business and the people to grow. In the position I find myself in I feel I must make an impact not just in the business but also in the careers and lives of the people who work for us.”

Grit and perseverance during COVID

The company is as strong as its team, says Wasif. “The team has shown a lot of grit and perseverance during the 1st and 2nd COVID waves when only the pharmacies were open. People had limited knowledge about COVID and there was a lot of anxiety.”

DVAGO has large resource pool of pharmacist. “These pharmacists were our frontline warriors during COVID, working long hours advising customer, guiding them on immunity boosting solutions and creating a calming impact by staying positive. A few days back I was in a MOU signing ceremony with a leading pharmaceutical company, and one of their directors told me how she would call our Call Center late in the night during COVID times to get her medicines delivered.”

Product sourcing

DVAGO only buys products directly from the

In formulating strategy and ensuring operational excellence I am focused on people, process and technology, says Wasif Khan. “Upon these three pillars depends business transformation.

DVAGO IN ACTION!

Wasif Working Towards his Vision
For Building New Businesses And
Young Talent Development



“DVAGO Board of Directors are visionary leaders who started DVAGO for providing best in class health and wellness products and services with the purpose of giving back to the communities we live in”

manufacturers or from their authorized distributors and ensuring medicine storage at the right temperatures. “DVAGO kept its prices at the regulated level and didn't respond to the extreme demand by hiking our prices even during COVID times. Running an ethical business is at the core of our business philosophy. We are here to give back to society and make a positive impact.”

Diversity & Inclusion

DVAGO outlets have more than one pharmacist in attendance. Most of our pharmacists are females.

We have created an environment in our branches where females feel safe and secure working in retail pharmacy which was not the case earlier. We have female doctors of pharmacy engaging with customers and advising them, and also working in the commercial aspect of how we can grow the business. Diversity and inclusion and the empowerment of females are prominent aspects of our business and a key strategic thrust.”

Building win-win partnership

Pharmacy is a low margin business, says Wasif. “However we are committed to invest and grow the pharmacy industry landscape. We are creating pharmacies with good infrastructure and qualified resources providing positive store ambience to the customer. Alongside we are aggressively expanding our branch network and increasing our footprint across cities and creating employment opportunities for people, business growth for pharmaceutical and consumer companies and providing customer/patient convenience and accessibility through our growing network. We look towards our business partners, pharmaceutical and consumer goods industries, to closely collaborate with us to further build long term win-win partnerships.”

Tax relief

“The government also needs to review and relax the taxation regime for chain pharmacies because we are making large investments and need to be supported.”

Own Brands

DVAGO has some own brands also but it is a hardcore pharmacy retail chain with 70% of its business being pharmaceutical products and 30% consumer products. “Our star own brand is the face mask which are arguably the

best face masks available. Its three layered melt brown and we make it in a way where there is no human touch involved. Then we have some analgesic balms and are working on some other products that we can bring to market to better serve our customers.”

Spirit of inquiry and critical thinking

Wasif Khan is a proper Karachi man. Schooled at Beaconhouse and DHA College, he acquired his MBA from the Institute of Business Management (IoBM) which, he says, went a long way in helping him understand the WHY of things. “I see around me a dearth of people who ask the WHY question. That's an important issue when we're looking at young leaders. Before getting into the WHAT and HOW we need to understand the WHY. At the IoBM we were taught through project based learning and the exploring of new ideas and engaging in innovation. It helped prepare me for the corporate world.”

As VP of the IoBM marketing society, Wasif and his team worked with their professors in conducting market research, and inviting corporate leaders to deliver talks, and made marketing plans for corporates as students. “My time at the IoBM was a most memorable and impactful part of my life.”

Prioritizing extracurricular

While the online gaming industry has taken over the extracurricular time of our kids it's very important that they get outdoors and engage in physical sports activity as well, emphasizes Wasif. “A healthy body makes for a healthy mind. Debating and the dramatic arts are alongside great extracurricular activities that sharpen the mind and enhance creativity and self-confidence. These are crucial to developing a well-rounded persona. I was fully involved with student life outside the classroom. In school I took part in both English and Urdu plays, and in college I was an active debater. Born leaders also need to be groomed and our school and college systems need to place more priority on their extracurricular programs.”

Preparing for eco-trouble

On the issue of climate change Wasif says it is real and is happening across the globe and even hardened cynics are now in agreement that this is due to human induced global warming. “Pakistan is amongst the most impacted

“Diversity and inclusion and providing equal opportunities to females is prominent aspect of DVAGO and a key strategic thrust.”

“Be positive about life and about yourself and others around you. Exude positivity. Inculcate within you a passion for winning and perseverance.”

countries by climate change. Our glaciers are melting causing unprecedented flooding of the Indus River. We have suffered from deadly heat waves and torrential rain that have brought our cities to a standstill, causing immeasurable loss in life and property and human suffering, not to mention the resultant economic losses. Drought is another clear and present danger and the shifting of the weather patterns is adversely impacting agriculture which is the mainstay of Pakistan.”

It's reassuring to see that the government is moving aggressively with countermeasures and there is a lot more awareness amongst our people about environmental issues, he says. “The government's forestation efforts are laudable, but alongside we must put a stop to deforestation that has caused havoc in the Northern areas through an increased incident of landslides because of an absence of trees whose roots help stabilize the mountain slopes.”

Mangroves Alert

Down South in Sindh, around Karachi especially, Wasif points to the Mangroves that are being chopped relentlessly and this must stop, he says, since the Mangroves are a critical coastal defense against storms and tsunamis and should be protected, apart from being the nursery for fish and shrimps, with its own splendid and awe-inspiring ecosystem through which one can paddle and enjoy the breathtaking bird life.

“While the government is doing what it can, we as individuals must raise our collective game in support of a clean and hygienic environment, and better forecast and prepare for the calamities that may beset us in the future. Victory belongs to the prepared.”

Challenging himself

Speaking of his pre-DVAGO career path, Wasif says he likes to challenge himself by working for Cadbury was one such getting out of his comfort zone. “At Cadbury I got to be the Zonal Head South for Sindh and Balochistan position at a fairly early age of 26. I was also part of the Cadbury change management team and was able to create an impact in the market. Moving from PepsiCo to startup scale-up proptech IMARAT Group/Graana.com was also case in point from moving out of comfort zone into Learning and Growth zone. Here he was able to learn the dynamics of start scale up business and online platforms.

Wasif believes in a positive attitude and working with passion and perseverance. “That's very important because career is a long haul Marathon and it's not a straight line. There are ups and downs in one's career and one has to persevere. That's what makes one stronger.”

PepsiCo – Dil Mangay Aur!

Wasif worked for PepsiCo International for 13 years in both the snacks business as well as the beverages business, and did different roles from regional sales manager to national sales development manager through strategy and operations and franchise management.

“My last role was as group chief operating officer for the North franchises of Pakistan. PepsiCo has been a major part of my 20 years career. I've always wanted to get out of my comfort zone and go into the learning and growth zones. That's why I looked for a new role in PepsiCo after every two years or so, and it helped me develop as a better professional. We live only once so it's important that we gain as much experience as possible in terms of the job roles that we do and the people we meet and the places we visit.”

Aligning with a higher purpose

Wasif has a keen interest in human psychology and is NLP Certified Coach & Practitioner. “I like to understand what people think and what triggers them, and how to motivate them and create win-win outcomes. A lot of us are unaware of our human potential. As Rumi once said, it's all within you. I'm also engaged in exploring and developing myself. I try to cascade my learning through mentoring and coaching of my teams. I tell our young folk that it's all very well being smart and sharp, but it's very important to align oneself with a higher purpose and exercise belief in Allah and self-belief. Then we can achieve anything once we set our minds to it.”

Wasif Khan is married with two kids, 14 and 10 years old, and he follows Simon Sinek for finding your WHY and knowing your WHY, which is very important, he says. Also on his reading list are Stephen Covey, Jim Collins, and Tony Robbins. “These days I am also reading Rumi and trying to understand life from a bigger perspective.”

Be positive

His message to the youth is to be a lifelong learner. “The moment one starts thinking one knows it all is when one's downfall begins. Alongside, the right attitude is extremely important for doing well on a long term basis both professionally and personally. Be positive about life and about yourself and others around you. Exude positivity. It's very important for one's own mental health as well as the health of the organization. Inculcate within you a passion for winning and perseverance.

Thank you Wasif Khan ■

Interviewed by Adil Ahmad, Special Correspondent, OCTARA.COM

What's Coming Next?

Reimagining Leadership, Productivity & the Workplace at the 5th Future Summit

What's coming next is a loaded question, but as the theme of the Future Summit's 5th edition it was quite appropriate. Given the state of flux both at home and abroad it's really anybody's guess as to what's coming next. We can take some reassurance, however, in the oft stated view of the eternal optimist Engineer Khalid Awan that "the best is yet to come."

Well done Azfar!

The Future Summit's 5th edition was co-hosted by the Martin Dow Group and Nutshell Group with Engro Corp as the Platinum Sponsors. The Founder and Chairman of the Nutshell Group, Azfar Ahsan, who is now battling for the Government, was present on the occasion in his capacity of Chairman Board of Investment (BOI) and Minister of State, with the Summit hosting assumed by the Chief Executive Strategic Engagements, Nutshell Group, Air Chief Marshal Sohail Aman (Rtd), ably and amply assisted by Rabia Shoaib Ahmad (Director & Chief Operating Officer, Nutshell Group) and the Summit emcee Sidra Iqbal, celebrated TV Journalist and a passionate development activist.

Savoring every bite

The sheer quantum of information generated at the Future Summit was fairly mindboggling, with information overload a clear and present danger for the faint of heart and feeble of mind. For them the advice on offer as articulated by a wise old man from a bygone era concerned the simple protocol of eating an elephant, one bite at a time, and for that the Nutshell Group's YouTube Channel beckoned with its very comprehensive cache of high quality audio-visual recordings of the event to be perused at one's leisure and pleasure, at ease in one's loungers, and not trussed up in tie and suit.

Battle Stations!

But the corporate warriors assembled here, hailing from the private, public and government sectors were all battle hardened veterans of the economy, trailblazers and



"Leadership is about getting work out of the people that you have. It's a bad craftsman that blames his tools" - Khalid Awan, Founder & Chairman, TCS Group of Companies

pathfinders in their own right. Ties and suits and shining boots were their daily armor as they went into battle against the best that the global village had to offer, pulling off victory after victory from the often gaping jaws of imminent defeat.

The finely calibrated thoughts came in fast and furious, from the starting bell with Ali Akhai's (Chairman, Martin Dow Group) opening remarks and the welcome note & Leadership Talk by Air Chief Marshal Sohail Aman (Rtd). Ehsan Malik's (CEO, Pakistan Business Council) address was up next and preceded the Keynote delivered by Dr. Shamshad Akhtar (Chairperson, Pakistan Stock Exchange & Karandaaz & Former Federal Minister for Finance & Former Governor, State Bank of Pakistan) which contained a message of hope tempered with caution.

Leadership in a Pandemic-Impacted World' was the subject of the Conversation with Ghias Khan (President & CEO, Engro Corporation & Vice President, OICCI) with Syed Veqar Ul Islam (CEO & Director, Jaffer Business Systems & Member Policy Board, SECP) as the Moderator.

The Guest of Honor Dr. Reza Baqir (Governor, State Bank of Pakistan) delivered his address on 'The Future of Pakistan's Economy' which was followed by the address of the Chief Guest Imran Ismail, the Governor of Sindh.

The future is NOW

The second session began with Muhammad Aurangzeb (President & CEO, Habib Bank Limited & Vice Chairman, Pakistan Business Council) in conversation with moderator Saquib Ahmad (Country Managing Director Pakistan & Afghanistan, SAP) on 'Innovating for Future'.

Leadership for New Economic Realities' came under fire in a panel discussion with a blue chip cast of bankers comprising Atif Bajwa (President & CEO, Bank Alfalah Limited), Shazad Dada (President & CEO, United Bank Limited), Yousaf Hussain (President & CEO, Faysal Bank Limited), Mohsin Nathani (President & CEO, Habib



Metropolitan Bank), Basir Shamsie (President & CEO, JS Bank) and Mohammad Shoaib CFA (CEO, Al Meezan Investment Management Limited) with Ayla Majid (Founder & CEO, Planetive) moderating the discussion.

Where's the juice?

The third session focused on 'Fixing Pakistan's Power Sector - The Way Forward' and the panelists comprised Lt Gen Muzammil Hussain (Retd) (Chairman, WAPDA), Syed Moonis Abdullah Alvi (CEO, K-Electric), Prof. Dr. Fiaz Chaudhry (Professor of Practice, Director LUMS Energy Institute & Werner-Von Siemens Chair), Ruhail Mohammed (CEO, Lucky Electric Power Company) and Ayla Majid (Founder & CEO, Planetive) with Aftab Mahmood Butt (Chief Executive Officer, KAPCO) moderating.

Plugging the gap

In the fourth session we witnessed a dialogue on 'Looking Ahead – Pakistan's Path to a Digital Economy'

with panelists Aamir Ibrahim (CEO, Jazz (VEON) & Chairman, Mobilink Micro finance Bank),

Irfan Wahab Khan (CEO, Telenor Pakistan & Chairman, Telenor Bank), Asif Peer (CEO, Managing Director & Member of the Board, Systems Limited), Dr. Ayesha K. Khan (Country Director Pakistan, Acumen & Board Member, Bank Alfalah Limited), Ammara Masood (CEO & President, NdcTech), and Ehsan Saya, MD Daraz.pk, with Saquib Ahmad (Country Managing Director Pakistan & Afghanistan, SAP) moderating.

Getting out of the box

The 5th Session and final session of day 1 of the Future Summit was on "Reimagining Leadership, Productivity & the Workplace" with panelists comprising Markus Erich Strohmeier (Managing Director & CEO, Siemens Pakistan), Khalid Awan (Founder & Chairman, TCS Group of Companies), Maheen Rahman (CEO, InfraZamin Pakistan), Javed Ghulam Mohammad (Group Managing Director & CEO, Martin Dow), Dr. Amjad Waheed (CEO, NBP Funds), and Ghazanfar Azzam (President & CEO, Mobilink Microfinance Bank Limited) with Farrukh Khan (CEO & Managing Director, Pakistan Stock Exchange) moderating proceedings and bringing out some great insights from the panelists.

Crystal ball gazing

Day 2 of the Future Summit's 5th edition began with its Sixth

Session which was an Address by Douglas Corley (Founder, DHB Global & CEO, Alaunius Technologies & Global Panel Member, MIT Technology) on the theme of the Summit 'What's Coming Next?' This was followed by Asif Akram (Chief Operating Officer, Systems Limited) speaking on 'Industry 5.0 - Digitally Enabled Enterprise'.

The Seventh Session had M. Haroon Qassim (Managing Director, PharmEvo (Pvt.) Ltd. & Shield Corporation) speaking on 'The Future of Healthcare' while Senator Dr. Musadik Malik (Chairman, Standing Committee on Water Resources, Senate of Pakistan) also graced the occasion with a few words.

Strategic realignments

The Eighth Session was on "China Pakistan Economic Corridor - The Way Forward" and the speakers were Hassan Aslam Shad (Legal Director, CMS Cameron McKenna Nabarro Olswang LLP) and Khalid Mansoor (Special Assistant to the Prime Minister on CPEC Affairs & Minister of State) with Sajjeed Aslam (Global Head of Public Sector, ACCA) moderating.

The Ninth and final Session of the 5th Future Summit addressed "Pakistan & Changing Geopolitical Scenario" and who better than Senator Mushahid Hussain Sayed, Chairman Defense Committee, Senate of Pakistan & Chairman, Pakistan China Institute to hold forth on this topic.

Outstanding success

The Future Summit's 5th edition, co-hosted by the Martin Dow Group and Nutshell Group with Engro Corp as the Platinum Sponsors, pulled off an extravagant, truly deluxe affair. There was much meat to chew on, both figuratively and literally.

Cutting to the chase

At the risk of seeming partial, which I am, I'll close this bare boned review with the thoughts expressed by Engineer Khalid Awan which hit the nail squarely on the head. Quoting from wisdom generated 2500 years ago by Sun Tzu and Confucius he said that leadership essence of their thinking came down to three things – the will to accomplish the mission; knowledge; and capability to execute. Within these parameters we can reimagine leadership, productivity & the workplace.

On a much stronger note Engineer Khalid Awan quoted contemporary philosopher Yuval Noah Harari who has said that human stupidity is a very powerful factor in human society, and we human beings have a capacity to overlook that which is very evident. Given the calamitous reality of global warming and climate change, one can't really argue with mister Harari ■

Watch recording of "Reimagining Leadership, Productivity & the Workplace"
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KCPWhiiklJo>

Review filed by **Adil Ahmad**, Special Correspondent, Octara.Com

IN 2022

INSPIRE YOURSELF TO SUCCEED IN BUSINESS AND LIFE

Kinetic Talent Digger
Kamran Ahmed Siddiqui
holds forth at TCS Octara Webinar



‘twas a Webinar steeped in storytelling and poetry, and calls to action. What use is a recipe if it’s not put to use, asked the Kinetic Talent Digger as he dug deep into the psyche of his substantial virtual audience to pry open the road blocks and release the brakes that were holding back the achieving of individual potential.

Exponential transformation

Kamran Ahmed Siddiqui held up the story of UAE’s transformation from a land of impoverished camel and goat herders to the leading entrepreneurial capital of the world with glittering skyscrapers and highways crammed with the most expensive automobiles.

“A few decades back the UAE was a backward desert society, unaware of the oil and gas bounties beneath their feet that had been there for thousands of years. Once they became aware of its presence it still didn’t do them any good until they developed a vision for their development and extracted and marketed that bounty. Are you aware of the bounty that exists within you? But being aware of its presence will not be enough to transform you until you dig deep and develop your inner assets, refine them and market them.”

Kamran is an accomplished professional with extensive 29 years of leadership experience in developing and

“When a person recognizes who he is the universe becomes visible to him in its entire splendor”

executing global & regional talent management business to drive sustainable business and cultural change. He is the founder of "Kinetic Talent Digger" talent Management Company based in USA & UAE, and has worked with various renowned Multinationals and other oil & Gas industry giants, and trained around 60,000+ mid to top level executives in almost 25 different countries around the globe.

Continuous improvement

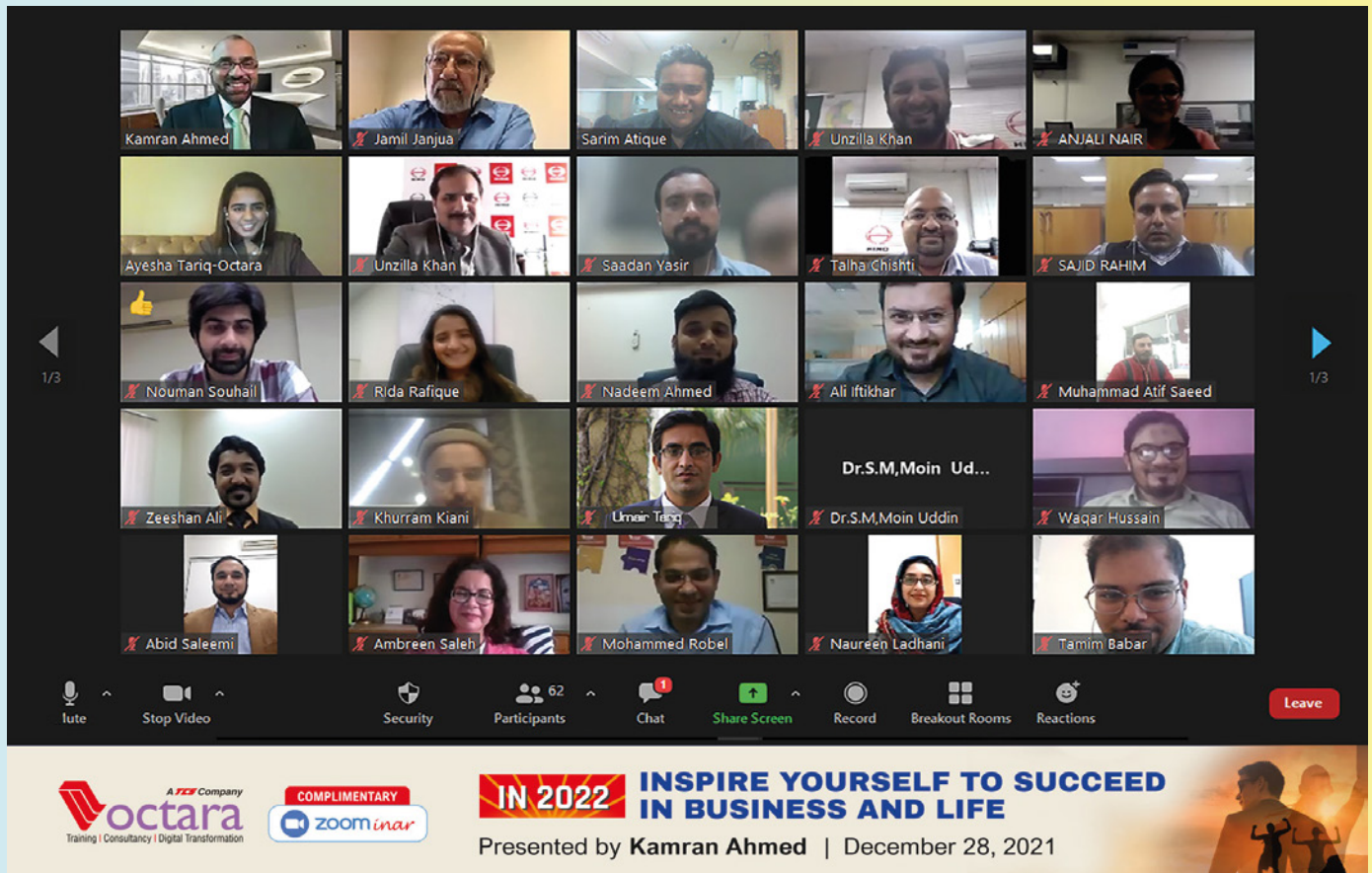
When a person recognizes who he is the universe becomes visible to him in its entire splendor, says Kamran. “Duub kay mun mein apnay paa jaa suraag e zindagi” said Allama Iqbal.” Roughly translated this Urdu couplet means to dive deep within your inner self to discover the essence of life.

“We need to regularly update and upgrade our knowledge base just as we do our smartphones, computer and toolkits to remain compatible. As we begin 2022 which version are you?” he asked, following up the question with another couplet ‘Teyri asal hasti sirf teyri sooch hai, baqi sub haddian aur ghost hai’ attributing it to Rumi with the meaning that the individual’s essence is his or her thoughts while the rest is just flesh and bones.

Kamran Khan is a great believer in Continuous improvement (Kaizan) and his advice is to ensure that one is compatible with the emerging future. “How much

To watch recording of Webinar

PLAY


<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1r7KboC1xJs&t=29s>


have you invested of your income upon yourself? What is your inspiration?"

Passion & purpose

A single event, even a single chance utterance can change you, he says. "Yeh baat alag hai kay tum na badlo, par zamana badal raha hai; gulab patthar pay khil rahay hain, chiraag aandhee mein jal raha hai; yehi junoon, yehi khawaab meyra hai, vahaan chiraag jala doon jahan andheyra hai." Translation – "It's a separate issue that you may not change but the times are changing; the rose is blossoming on a rock, the oil lamp is burning bright in the midst of a tempest; this is my passion and this is my dream; to light a lamp where there is darkness." It's better to light a candle than curse the darkness is a phrase often heard in the corridors of philanthropy.

If we can possess a big vision then all other things automatically fall into place, said Kamran Khan, gifting

"A single event, even a single chance utterance can change you"

Comments from the participants during Kamran's webinar

Excellent Session!

- Malik Nouman Souhail Awan, Ufone

Great Session! Highly Motivational,

- Talha Chishti, Hinopak Motors Limited

It was outclass session and was perfectly executed.

- Ali Iftikhar, Midas Safety

Very interesting technique of storytelling used to keep the audience's attention! The personal examples pulled the listeners in and involved them in the speakers' life story and success.

- Ambreen Saleh, Orange Tree

the webinar participants with his e-book '24 Gold Coins'. "Until the age of 24 I was shy, introverted and lacking in self-confidence. Today I address hundreds of people without hesitation. You have to face your fears. I was thrown into the deep end by my mentor who asked me quite unexpectedly to conduct a large meeting."

Spread the joy

Remove your internal constraints and barriers, and once you have achieved success and recognition help others overcome their constraints was the price his mentor extracted in lieu of his helping Kamran find his direction.

"This session is an extension of that commitment that I made. My mentor gave me such a big canvas that the small things in life stopped mattering. He gave me a sense of contribution while my father imbued in me a firm sense of giving. It matters not how much one gives. The giving is seen in the context of how much you have. Giving extends beyond money and to the sharing of anything of value that one possesses, in particular knowledge and time."

Auschwitz-Birkenau

To further emphasize his point, Kamran Khan narrated the harrowing tale of Viktor Frankl, an eminent psychologist who, along with his entire family in 1944 was consigned to Auschwitz-Birkenau, the largest of the Nazi concentration and death camps located in southern Poland.

Opened in 1940, Auschwitz-Birkenau initially served as a detention center for political prisoners. However, it evolved into a network of camps where Jewish people and other perceived enemies of the Nazi state were exterminated, often in gas chambers, or used as slave labor. Some prisoners were also subjected to barbaric

**"If we can possess a big vision
then all other things automatically
fall into place"**

medical experiments led by Josef Mengele (1911-79).

During World War II (1939-45) more than 1 million people, by some accounts, lost their lives at Auschwitz. In January 1945, with the Soviet army approaching, Nazi officials ordered the camp abandoned and sent an estimated 60,000 prisoners on a forced march to other locations. When the Soviets entered Auschwitz they found thousands of emaciated detainees and piles of corpses left behind.

**"During COVID people became
heightened versions of
themselves. Positive people
became even more positive and
negative people became worse"**

"Man's Search for Meaning"

Viktor Frankl survived at Auschwitz-Birkenau for 4 years, and in 1946 wrote his seminal book "Man's Search for Meaning" chronicling his experiences as a prisoner and describing his psychotherapeutic method that helped him survive which involved identifying a purpose in life to feel positive about, and then immersively imagining that outcome. It came to be known as Logotherapy, a form of psychotherapy that is focused on the future and on our ability to endure hardship and suffering through a search for purpose. Needless to say Frankl's theories were heavily influenced by his personal experiences of suffering and loss in Nazi concentration camps and founded on the belief that human nature is motivated by the search for a life purpose.

Heightened versions

"He documented the way different people handle adversity," said Kamran. "Events hold no meaning in life except the meaning you assign to those events. During COVID people became heightened versions of themselves. Positive people became even more positive and negative people became worse. Positive people rushed out to rescue others who were tottering. Nobody or anything can deprive you of your power of choice. Event + (Interpretation x Response) = Outcome."

After such a powerful and slightly overwhelming pitch the emergence of another couplet was expected from Kamran Khan, and he did not disappoint. "Har harf rut kay bhi aagahi naheen milti, aag naam rakhnay say roshni naheen milti, aadmi say insaan tak jub aaogay tou samjho gay, kyun chiraag kay neechay roshni naheen milti." Translation – "Memorizing every word does not knowledge make; merely naming an object (fire) does not produce results (light); it's when you evolve from mere human to human being will you understand; why there is no light beneath the lamp." It is the resourcefulness state that the poet alludes to.

“There are stated and implied needs and exceeding expectations brings a joyful response and enhances the quality of life”

Release your mental brakes!

Further elaboration was on its way. “Tag kay badalnay say content naheen batalta.” The container’s value changes with the change in its content. A bottle of water may at some point also contain milk or honey.

“What value do we bring to the table? Increase your capacity. Are you willing to spend 10% of your income on your development? I’m a life-long learner and have been researching what makes people successful. Everything rotates around the customer and supplier. There are stated and implied needs and exceeding expectations brings a joyful response and enhances the quality of life.”

The Ant

The subject of being a Good Samaritan is so vast that it requires deep drilling to comprehend, and deep drilling is amongst Kamran Khan’s top takeaways. He quoted from Surah an-Naml (the Ant) of the Holy Quran. “Until, when they came upon the valley of the ants, an ant said, ‘O ants enter your dwellings that you not be crushed by Hazrat Suleyman and his soldiers while they perceive not.’” Hazrat Suleyman smiled in amusement at her words, and prayed, “My Lord! Inspire me to always be

“You become successful when you strive hard to make other people like yourself successful”

thankful for Your favours which You have blessed me and my parents with, and to do good deeds that please you. Admit me, by Your mercy, into “the company of” Your righteous servants.”

You become successful when you strive hard to make other people like yourself successful, said Kamran. “You must become beneficial for others and leave the rest to the benevolence of Allah.” Further fortifying his contention Kamran Khan came out with more than just a couplet this time.

The Power of One

“Tu apni khoobian dekh, khamayaan batanay ko log

hain na; p yar karna hai tou khud say kar, dushmani karnay ko log hain na; agar rakhna hai kadam tou aagay rakh, peechay khainchnay ko tou log hain na; sapnay dekhnay hain tou oonchay dekh, neecha dekhana kay leay tou log hain na; bharosa rakhna hai tou khud pay rakh, shak karnay kay leay tou log hain na; agar banani hain tou yadien bana, batien banana kay leay tou log hain na; tu khud ki alag pehchaan bana, bheer mien chalnay kay leay tou log hain na.”

Translation – “Look at your strengths, for there will be others to point out your weaknesses; if you must love then love yourself, for there will be others to engage with in enmity; take a firm step forward and upward, for there will be others to pull you backward and downward; if you must dream then dream big, for there will be others to make you feel small; if you must depend on someone then depend upon yourself, for there will be others to put you in doubt; if you must make something then make worthwhile memories, for there will be others to make frivolous talk; make your own distinct identity, for there will be others to make up the crowd.”

Investigate & experiment

2022 is going to be a different year, said Kamran, sounding hopeful. “Don’t be fearful of experimentation. Expand your outreach. Investigate your personality type. I spent 8 years of my life experiencing the Pakistan landscape. I had the most satisfaction and enjoyment while working in Karachi which is what refined me. Overseas I have interacted with different cultures and found it very educative and my social skills got refined. I have kept myself in the growth mindset, thinking of myself as a learner and a sponge for knowledge.”

Focus on your desired outcomes, and not the ones that you don’t like, was Kamran Khan’s parting shot. “You have the ability to choose, and I strongly recommend that you choose self-development every time. When experiencing a setback do not consider yourself to be a failure. Your chosen methods may have failed. Your strategy may have failed. You need to change it and not take failure personally. Get clinical. Explore other possibilities. Become more creative. Focus on attaining your goals.”

TCS Octara CEO, Jamil Janjua, thanked Kamran Khan for what he termed as a very engaging, inspiring and passionate presentation full of useful nuggets which he could fully relate with given the TCS Octara motto “helping you succeed”■

Webinar reviewed by **Adil Ahmad**, Special Correspondent, Octara.Com

To watch recording of Webinar



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1r7KboC1xJs&t=29s>

Worrying Notes & ACTION STATIONS!



COP26 has come and gone, and Glasgow, its host city, has hit the headlines as the birthplace of the Industrial Revolution that unleashed fossil fuels upon the world as the route to the attainment of ‘progress and prosperity’.

Peace, which should have been the logical outcome of progress and prosperity, has however eluded us, and it is now well established that we will have to sacrifice a great deal of our so-called progress and prosperity to reclaim some part of the peace that we may have enjoyed in the pre-Industrial Revolution period.

Too much of a good thing is bad, they say, and that has come to be true in this case in a very big way as we stand tottering on the brink of a fossil fuel induced precipice, facing a global calamity of epic proportions as Mother Nature hits back at mankind’s wanton behavior through

“The world is not prepared for a major disaster on a scale that spreads across the planet unimpeded and totally out of control”
— Robert Hunziker

global warming induced climate change.

How did we come to become wanton in our ways is the million dollar question facing social scientists around the world even as human resource development practitioners grapple with ways and means to bring about a radical change in our mindsets.

What is required now to stave off an extinction level event is an appeal to the Creator’s mercy manifest in a drastic reduction in our consumption habits as we swear off our gluttonous behavior while cultivating more empathy for

the less privileged. We must strive to win back Allah’s favor by doing a whole lot more with a whole lot less.

Meanwhile, we must bear the burden of our past follies, and it is this burden that I intend to highlight in this column by bringing onto the radar the downside consequences of our existence which we would much rather remain blissfully unaware of. The time is upon us, however, to face the music, quickly overcome the paralysis of analysis which must necessarily result, and equally quickly plot a path to redemption and recovery.

Thwaites ‘Doomsday’ Glacier

On the global front there are two bits of bad news that need highlighting in this column. Let’s begin with the Thwaites ‘Doomsday’ Glacier in West Antarctica that is spooking scientists. Satellite images shown at a recent meeting of the American Geophysical Union showed numerous large diagonal cracks extending across the Thwaites floating ice wedge which is 80 miles across and 4000 feet deep with a 28 mile cracking ice shelf that extends over the Amundsen Sea.

Of special interest because of the underlying threat posed by Thwaites, the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) COP26 in November 2021 in Glasgow was panned by scientists as one more sleepy affair, failing to come to grips with the Western Civilizations biggest challenge since the Huns trampled Rome, writes Robert Hunziker in The News (18-12-21).

“This outrageous failure by the world’s leaders, evidenced by weak-kneed proposals, is decidedly threatening to coastal cities throughout the world, especially with the Thwaites glacier showing signs of impending collapse.”

The world is not prepared for a major disaster on a scale that spreads across the planet unimpeded and totally out

“Methane and CO2 escaping from long-frozen soil could accelerate warming and overwhelm global efforts to cap the rise in Earth’s temperature at livable levels”

— Kimberley Miner

of control, he writes. “In that regard it is unfortunate that the world’s leaders have failed to take adequate measures, especially since scientists have been warning for decades of dire consequences for a failure to limit and stop CO2 emissions.”

After a long spell I was at Karachi’s once fabled French Beach on Christmas Eve just past, and I sensed something was not right though I couldn’t immediately put my finger on it. Then it struck me. The Arabian Sea was lapping on the shore far too close to the palatial ‘huts’ that adorn the seaside. It was at a level normally witnessed during the stormy Monsoon months and not at the height of winter when the waters have receded many meters further back making room for an expansive sandy beach. There was hardly any beach.

Further down the Sindh coast sea intrusion has rendered barren hundreds of thousands of acres of erstwhile fertile arable land. Is anyone in our scientific community studying the impact of the Thwaites glacier on our coastline as it slips and slides into the sea, especially upon our commercial capital Karachi?

Arctic permafrost thawing

The other bit of bad news on the global front is the thawing of the Arctic permafrost laden with billions of tons of greenhouse gases that threatens life across the planet, according to a comprehensive scientific review quoted by AFP in The News (13-1-22).

Methane and CO2 escaping from long-frozen soil could accelerate warming and overwhelm global efforts to cap the rise in Earth’s temperature at livable levels. Blanketing a quarter of the northern hemisphere’s landmass, permafrost contains twice the carbon currently in the atmosphere. Temperatures in the Arctic region have risen two to three times more quickly over the last half century than for the world as a whole.

Permafrost has warmed on average 0.4 degrees Celsius between 2007 and 2016 raising concerns about the rapid rate of thaw and potential old carbon release, note researchers led by Kimberley Miner, a scientist at the California Institute of Technology’s Jet Propulsion Laboratory.

Exposure of highly combustible organic matter no longer locked away by ice is also fuelling unprecedented wild fires that rapidly expand the layer of permafrost subject to thawing. As the climate warms these remote uncontrolled blazes are projected to increase 130% to 350% by mid-century, releasing more and more permafrost carbon.

On the local front people are migrating from the coastal areas due to water scarcity, the Sindh Minister for Environment, Climate Change and Coastal Development has claimed (Dawn 13-1-22), specifying Badin and its adjoining areas where livestock, fisheries and agriculture have taken a severe hit.

Fight back

The good news is that Oxfam has come to the rescue, amongst others. An international NGO that’s been working in Pakistan since 1973, Oxfam is helping create climate-smart agricultural solutions in coastal communities, developing an embankment to protect communities in Badin from sea intrusion and developing local adaptation plans of action for climate change and food security. Alongside, the Australian government is funding a project called Building Resilient Communities in Pakistan.

“Oxfam is helping create climate-smart agricultural solutions in coastal communities, developing an embankment to protect communities in Badin from sea intrusion and developing local adaptation plans of action for climate change and food security”

Two pieces of inherited wisdom come to mind as one surveys the battlefield. God helps those who help themselves. In that department more, much more certainly needs to be done, especially by the administrators of the public’s trust and taxes. The other piece of advice passed down through the ages is that success and happiness are journeys and not destinations. Every small step in the right direction, every drop no matter how insignificant it might seem in the greater scheme of the ocean, is worthy of applause and celebration. May Allah keep us all in His protection, Ameen ☸

Column by **Adil Ahmad**, Special Correspondent, OCTARA.COM

Which came first the Chicken or the Egg?

The answer to this question is neither right nor is it wrong.

A blog by Rose-marie Fernandez M.A., CPC, ELI-MP

Published in Jan 25, 2022



It's a brand spanking new year and the second month is almost upon us. We are soon to enter the third year of existing in the pandemic. Who would have thought that we had the endurance and resilience to survive this time? We have and we did. Uncertainties are realities of this world. Consequently, many questions have arisen in our minds that are exacerbated by our surroundings and environment. We must understand that there are answers to some questions and none for others. However, we need to decide whether or not we are willing to wait for the responses before we move on. Are we willing to wait for the chicken or the egg?

These last two years have taught us that not all questions have answers or not the answers that we are looking for. So, we question ourselves. But whatever the answer is to all of our questions, it will be neither right nor wrong. Because there is no such thing as wrong only an opportunity to grow and learn. It will be right for whoever answers it as right and if you think it is wrong then you are correct.

And so, the questions of the day are:

Why is it that we are in constant search of being right?

Why do we give being right so much importance?

Why are we looking for what is wrong?

What is wrong with us?

Nothing actually. If only we can accept that we were created perfect. External validation is not necessary. It is only our internal validation that matters. There are no responses to questions that exist outside of you. The only right answer, is the one that is right in front of you. The one that we may not want to accept. Why do we not want to accept it? Because we are so afraid that if we were wrong, then what? The concept of the answer being right or wrong is by definition one of our very own creations. A piece of work that we create. A movie. What is wrong for me may be very right for you

and vice versa. So, there is no one size fits all approach to getting the right answer. There is no mathematical formula in existence that when put it thru BODMAS it will give us consistent results.

So then, why is it important for us to be in pursuit of being right?

A question worthy of rumination.

WE are all knowing. All answers come from within us.

So then, if we have all the answers lie within us, what is it that prevents us from listening to and accepting our inner voice. Is it our fear of being wrong? – and who is that Judge that discerns what is wrong. We, we ourselves play Judge, Jury and Executioner all three roles at the same time, and thwart our movement forward, sentencing ourselves to be prisoners of the fear of being wrong.

Living in fear is not living at all. As I write this, I think of Whitney Houston's famous and beautiful song "The greatest love of all" and how her life ended so tragically, running away from her own fears.

Living in fear is not living at all. As I write this, I think of Whitney Houston's famous and beautiful song "The greatest love of all" and how her life ended so tragically, running away from her own fears.

Living in fear is living in a world of unworthiness, living in a world of self-depreciation, living in a world of self-deprivation. Is that what we want for ourselves?

As we move through this New Year, lets begin it by letting go and releasing ourselves of all that we fear and give ourselves permission to know that we are right for ourselves no matter what, give ourselves permission to discover and experience our own unique worthiness, give ourselves permission to cross borders that we never dared to enter. In so doing, conquer our fears and embrace an intentional life of abundance ■

Source:

<https://coachingworx.ca/which-came-first-the-chicken-or-the-egg/>



Rose-marie Fernandez is a Human Resources expert, worked with several fortune 500 companies in the South Asian sub-continent, USA and Canada. She has been recognized Professional Certified Coach (PCC) and credentialed by the International Coaching Federation (ICF). Rose is also Founder & Transformational Coach at Coaching Worx, Canada. She is exclusively working with Octara for her online trainings.

For Inquiries, info@octara.com



The end of Customer Service?

by Ron Kaufman

Hello,
I've been teaching about the importance of customer service for decades now... since long before most businesses fully realized how customer service impacts the bottom line.

So it's been gratifying in recent years to see so many business leaders acknowledge the importance of treating their customers well.

But providing good customer service is only the start.

What we need now is authentic customer care.

As the world gets more complex and more challenging, we all need to care more for one another. And that means genuinely caring about the future wellbeing of your customers, not just their current level of satisfaction. (That goes for your employees and the communities in which you operate, as well.)

I believe the business world is finally ready for this evolution.

Over the last two years, I've had numerous conversations with business leaders who are looking for ways their organizations can do more and do better. They now understand that uplifting service and authentic care are necessary to survive and thrive in the coming years.

So in that spirit... here are some resources for creating a culture of service and care in YOUR organization

Listen to this podcast episode on [Careology and The Circle of Care](#) and discover how to take the lead with authentic care.

Learn more about [Succeeding with Service in Turbulent Times](#).

Discover why [The Future of Service is Care](#) – and what that means for you and your organization.

Read my book, Uplifting Service and discover [why we're facing a service crisis](#) and what we can do about it.

Check out our Harvard-cited white paper and learn [the 4 proven rules for engineering a service transformation](#) in your organization.

[Evaluate your existing service culture](#) and discover how to improve by using our assessment library.

Enjoy these resources... and know that I have lots more ideas, insight, and training headed your way in the new year. We are navigating this fast-changing world together... and the better we care for one another, the more successful each of us will be ■

Article from Ron Kaufman. www.upliftingservice.com



Ron Kaufman is the globally recognized Service Guru, Author of New York Times bestseller book, and Founder of UP! Your Service. He is exclusively working with Octara for his workshops in Pakistan since 2012.

For Inquiries, info@octara.com

How to Spot A Leader?

Global Entrepreneur Xchange



How many times have you bought a nice book with a view to expanding your perspective? Then you rifle through a few pages and leave that book permanently on your shelf to collect dust! How many times have you bought a cool pair of sneakers with a vow to run every day and get back to shape? You run for a couple of days and slowly this idea of running becomes an unbearable chore and gradually your vision for fitness gets consigned to history! Finishing what you start is the single most important and under rated attribute of leadership.



Here is why finishing what you start sets you on the road to leadership.

1. When you finish what you start – you feel energised and confident.
2. You also become reliable in your own eyes and in the eyes of others – this builds an inner strength and resolve inside you which makes you win the trust of everyone.
3. When you make this a habit – you actually become a truly powerful person who takes ownership of every initiative you start. That is why true leadership is nothing but taking complete ownership!

So, finish what you start and watch the magic unfold in your business and life!

Who should read this?

1. CEOs looking for outstanding talent to fill up leadership positions
2. Entrepreneurs who are frustrated at the lack of progress made by their business
3. Startups that are still looking for the right product market fit

A billionaire who failed 5127 times...



James Dyson, a billionaire, inventor and designer failed 5,126 times to create the world's first bagless vacuum cleaner using a unique technology called the volcano technology. Well, he managed to get it perfectly right on the 5127th time. He then not only made history, but also billions!

All leaders finish what they start. That is why we admire them.

When you start something, finish it! ■

Source:

<https://globalentrepreneur.ebemails.com/emailviewinbrowser?nid=6463556275929088&eid=6645958984073216>

Lifelong Learning Tips

Contributions from TCS Octara People!!!

The 'Lifelong Learning Tips' is a self-learning and self-development process for promoting continuous learning among Octara people and shared with readers. Octara people are provided with business publications and then asked to choose and reflect their thoughts, perspectives and opinions based on their selected article in the Fortnightly octara.com e-Newsletter.

Each contributor further discusses and shares their learnings in the weekly 'Glue Meeting' held every Friday among the team mates. Basically, it's a 360 Degree Personal Development Drive from reading to selecting to understanding to explaining the thoughts perceived.

Hope readers find it as interesting and useful as the TCS Octara Team does !!

To Deal With Conflict Among Your Colleagues:

In this article there are some useful tips to resolve conflicts among your team members.

Ask people who have difference of opinion to summarize each other's remarks this might help them with learning other's idea better

Work out a compromise by building consensus by way of engaging in give and take situation then, at last settle on an answer.

Request every team member to list what the opposite side suggest, select and test a trade-off to check whether it matches with team goals.

Have each side compose 10 questions for their opponents. This will permit them to flag their central

issues about the opposite side's position and the responses might prompt a compromise.

Persuade colleagues that at times they might need to admit they're wrong. Help them in understanding that changing a position shows strength.

Regard the specialists in the group. Give their viewpoints more weightage when there is a need to use their expertise, however don't include conflicting sentiments



Contribution by **Sarim Atique**
Assistant Manager Business Development
Octara Private Limited - A TCS Company
Source: Communication Briefings

Be Your Own Turnaround Specialist

Robert S. "Steve" Miller Jr. is a well-respected specialist who gained his good reputation in 1980 as Chrysler's lead negotiator during its near-death loan bailout experience. He subsequently led turnarounds for four other ailing companies—one reason he knows a thing or two about what to do. Miller's advice:

1. Tell the truth. You have only one thing to sell: your personal credibility. Good or bad, tell people the way it is and tell it to anyone with a right to know. That includes your board of directors, stockholders and your employees. You're going to need people's support—and they'll give it to you—if they can trust what you tell them.

2. Act. Don't study things to death.

A lot of the things you should do are pretty obvious.

Do them.

3. Listen to customers. You'll be surprised just how perceptive they can be about what needs to be done.

4. Listen to your people. Don't make the mistake of becoming insulated from what's really happening. Talk to people. Listen to what they tell you. If you join a group already sitting at a table in the cafeteria, ask "How's it going?" You can learn a lot, some of it surprising. Make it easy for people to tell you surprising things in other ways. Give out your e-mail address and acknowledge every message you receive.



Contribution by **M. Shahzad**
Office Support
Octara Pvt. Ltd. - A TCS Company
Source: Leadership Strategies - 2004

Bob Keeshan's Leadership Lessons

As a child, Britton Keeshan took leadership inspiration from the same source as many of us. He was the grandson of 1960s TV kid-show star "**Captain Kangaroo**" —the late Bob Keeshan. The younger Keeshan now a 22 year-old college student—has set out to climb the tallest mountain peaks on seven continents. He believes the lessons that he learned from his grandfather will help him earn the record for the youngest person to climb the "**seven summits?**"

"My grandfather taught me to push the boundaries and seek the outer limits of whatever I was doing. His memory will be pushing me to strive harder than I've ever strived before," Keeshan said.



Contribution by **M. Umair Tariq**
Admin & Accounts Executive
Octara Private Limited - A TCS Company
Source: The Wall Street Journal,

Encourage Risk-taking or Lose Creativity

Leaders who fail to encourage risk-taking face an even greater risk: a stagnant business caused by managers who can't make decisions because they fear making a mistake.

Former Johnson & Johnson CEO James Burke learned that lesson from General Johnson himself when Burke developed a \$1 million product that tanked. When Burke was called to Johnson's office, he was sure he was going to be fired. Instead, Johnson congratulated him and said, *"All business is making decisions, and if you don't make decisions, you won't*

have any failures." Johnson warned Burke that he would be fired if he made the same mistake again, but made sure the rising young star knew that taking risks was part of leading.

Creativity dies in an atmosphere where people are afraid to take risks.



Contribution by **M. Nazim Ansari**
Creative Manager
Octara Private Limited - A TCS Company
Source: Leadership Strategies, May 2004

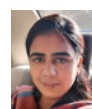
Top-level Efficiency Advice That Works

The article is about secret of success, giving examples of Bob Moffat who ran IBM'S Personal –computer business.

The first secret of Bob Moffat is 'efficiency' and this was achieved simply by waking up early in the morning and reaching office between 5:00am to 6:00am every day. The reason for reaching this early is not immerse in work; rather he used that uninterrupted time to think. The other secret is that; he used to talk straight and expect the same from his management team. One of his trademarks phrases 'Let's not perfume the pig'. He was very clear in communicating his message across and wanted truth

in return and wanted to hear bad news early.

Another secret of Moffat was that he used to conduct brainstorming session to prepare his managers for future. He was very conscious of time and uses to reach every meeting on time which helped him being on track and symbolized his own accountability and respect for his colleague.



Contribution by **Ayesha Tariq**
Product Specialist Training
Octara Pvt. Ltd. - A TCS Company
Source: Leadership Strategies

Readers are encouraged to share their comments and feedback on the e-Newsletter with us at **ayesha.tariq@octara.com** for inclusion in our upcoming issues.
Don't forget to send your recent picture and complete contact details.

OCTARA TRAINING PROGRAMS IN FEBRUARY 2022



A **FEZ** Company
Training | Consultancy | Digital Transformation

For Detailed Brochure



Click or Scan the QR code

BEARING DAMAGE ANALYSIS

February 9-10, 2022 | Nine Tree Hotel, Lahore | 10:00 AM to 5:00 PM*



Workshop Facilitator:
KHURRAM SHAHZAD



A **FEZ** Company
Training | Consultancy | Digital Transformation

ONLINE  TRAINING

*Re-invent your Organization
Post-Covid with John Bentley*

For Detailed Brochure



Click or Scan the QR code

Strategic Thinking & Planning

February 15, 2022 | 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM PKT Via Zoom.



Facilitator:
John Bentley



A **FEZ** Company
Training | Consultancy | Digital Transformation

17 February 2022
Regent Plaza | 2:00 to 5:00pm

THINK AGAIN!

Future-proof your Brand & Marketing Strategy

Facilitator: **Sarah Dawood**

For Detailed Brochure



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Performance Management

February 23, 2022 - Regent Plaza, Karachi *
10:00 am to 5:00 pm



Workshop Facilitator:
FARHAN MAHMOOD

For Detailed Brochure



Click or Scan the QR code

COMPENSATION & BENEFITS

February 24, 2022 | Regent Plaza, Karachi *
10:00am to 5:00pm

Topics of Trainings	Duration	Trainer Name	Date	Loc.
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FEBRUARY

Workshop: Bearing Damage Analysis	2-Day	Khurram Shahzad	9-10 Feb	Lahore
Workshop: Strategic Thinking & Planning	1-Day	John Bentley	15-Feb	Zoom
New Workshop: Think Again Future Proof your Brand and Marketing	Half day	Sarah Dawood	17-Feb	Karachi
Workshop: Performance Management	1-Day	Farhan Mahmood	23-Feb	Karachi
Workshop: Compensation & Benefit	1-Day	Farhan Mahmood	24-Feb	Karachi

MARCH

Complimentary Webinar: i-Thrive	60 min	Rose-Marie	08-Mar	Zoom
Workshop: Best Secretarial Practices	1-Day	Zaufyshan Haseeb	09-Mar	Karachi
Workshop: Negotiation Skills	1-day	Haseeb Hasan	09-Mar	Karachi
New: Workshop: Bearing System Design	1-Day	Khurram Shahzad	10-Mar	Karachi
Online Training: Advanced Excel & Dashboard Designing	5-Hours	Irfan Bakaly	15-Mar	Zoom
Online Training: Hire the Best	5-Hours	Rahila Narejo	22-Mar	Zoom
Workshop: Sales Management for Pharma Professional	1-day	Talib Faruqui	26-Mar	Karachi
Online Training: Managing the Training Function	2-hours	Ayesha Tariq	29-Mar	Zoom

UPCOMING PROGRAMS IN 2022

Supply Chain Management	Half-day	Bob Forshay	TBC	TBC
Conflict Management	1-day	Faizan Ahmad	TBC	TBC
Impactful Communication	Half-day	Arshi Aziz	TBC	TBC
Learning & Development	Half-day	Farhad Karamally	TBC	TBC
Online Training: Business English Course (Every Saturday)	3-hours	Shahid Mirza	TBC	Zoom
Workshop: Human Resources in the Age of Digital Transformation	1-Day	Dr. Frank Peter	TBC	Karachi
Workshop: Digital Marketing Masterclass	1-Day	Dr. Frank Peter	TBC	Karachi
Online Training: Growth Mindset for Abundance	3-hours	Rose-marie	TBC	Zoom
Workshop: Blue Ocean Strategy	2-Day	Dr. Raj Kumar	TBC	Karachi
Workshop: Email Writing Etiquettes	Half-Day	TBC	TBC	Karachi
Online Training: 21 Effective Brainstorming Techniques	1-Day	Dave Nelissen	TBC	Karachi
Understanding Fintech, Cryptocurrencies & Blockchain	TBC	Petros Geroulanos	TBC	Karachi
Designing Agile Organizations	2-Day	Fredrick Haentjens	TBC	Karachi



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